FIGHTERBASE

Time-restricted eating

Diet guide

All food within a set window, e.g. 8 hours.



Prepared 11 October 2026 for FighterBase members. Eating styles library, one of a set.

> DRAFT: not yet reviewed by a registered dietitian. General information only, not medical advice. Check with your doctor or a registered dietitian before changing how you eat, especially if you have a medical condition, are pregnant, or are under 18.

USING FIGHTERBASE

How to use this diet guide

This diet guide is part of your eating styles library in the FighterBase app. The pages that follow are built to be skimmed. You do not need to read it all at once.

1. **Open Nutrition**
   In the app, open the **Nutrition** tab and tap **Eating styles**.

2. **Tap Time-restricted eating**
   Read the short summary, what to eat, what to go easy on, and what to watch.

3. **Follow it**
   Tap **Follow this style**. Recipes and the Foods list then filter to match, so you only see what fits. You can follow more than one style.

4. **Download the PDFs**
   Use **Full food list** and **Diet guide** to save these to your phone. Handy for the shop or a restaurant.

5. **Log it and train**
   Meals you log count towards your day. Spend your energy on training, not on reading labels.

> Looking for the full list of foods? Download the **Full food list** PDF from the same screen. It names every allowed and avoided food.

THE BASICS

What is Time-restricted eating?

When you eat, not what. All meals fit in a daily window (16:8 is common: 16 hours without food, 8 hours eating). Combine with any style.

Where it comes from

Time-restricted eating (also called intermittent fasting in its daily form) limits eating to a set window each day, such as 8 to 12 hours, with water, black coffee and plain tea allowed outside it. It focuses on when you eat, not what.

The main ideas

1. Pick an eating window (for example 10am to 6pm, or 12 to 8pm) and stick to it most days.
2. Outside the window: water, black coffee and plain tea only.
3. Inside the window: eat proper meals with enough protein and carbs.
4. The 16:8 plan (16 hours fasting, 8 hours eating) is the most common. Shorter fasts like 12:12 or 14:10 are gentler.
5. Total food still matters: eating less overall is what changes weight.

Who it suits

- People who like simple rules about timing
- People who do not want breakfast
- People who snack in the evening and want a cut-off

Talk to your doctor or a registered dietitian first if:

- You have diabetes or take medication that needs food
- You are pregnant, breastfeeding or under 18
- You have ever had an eating disorder
- You are training hard or cutting weight for a fight
- You have low blood pressure or feel faint easily

TRAINING

Fuel for training

- Train inside your eating window or soon after the first meal where you can. Fasted hard sessions can feel flat and are not required.
- If you train fasted, keep it light, and eat a proper meal with protein and carbs afterwards.
- Make sure you still hit protein and total calories in a shorter window: three decent meals or two big ones plus a snack.
- Drink water through the fasting period and add salt if you get headaches.

> Try to fit a meal before and after harder sessions inside your window. Early-morning training with a late window can leave you under-fuelled.

Nutrients to keep an eye on

Protein
preserve muscle
Where: meat, fish, eggs, dairy, tofu, beans

Fluids and electrolytes
avoid headaches and cramps
Where: water, broth, salt, potassium-rich foods

Carbohydrate
session fuel
Where: rice, potatoes, oats, fruit, bread

Fibre
gut health
Where: vegetables, fruit, beans, whole grains

Common mistakes

- Training hard fasted and under-fuelling
- Squeezing too little food into the window
- Treating the window as permission to eat anything
- Skipping meals around fight camp or cutting weight without professional advice

EVERYDAY LIFE

Labels, eating out and swaps

Reading labels

- Technically breaks a fast: anything with calories (milk, sugar, juice, most 'diet' drinks that carry calories, bone broth, creamers)
- Usually fine outside the window: water, plain tea, black coffee, sparkling water
- Supplements: check for calories, e.g. BCAAs, gummies

Eating out

- Plan meals inside the window and book accordingly.
- Eat a proper meal at the start of the window.
- Alcohol counts as calories: keep it inside the window and light.

Easy swaps

Evening snacking	→	Close the kitchen after your last meal
Breakfast on the go	→	Black coffee until the window opens
Sugary coffee	→	Black coffee or tea, then a proper meal

Timing guide

Item	During the fast	In the eating window
Water, sparkling water	Fine	Fine
Black coffee, plain tea	Fine (no sugar, milk or cream)	Fine
Coffee with milk, sugar or cream	Breaks the fast	Fine
Fruit juice, smoothies, sports drinks	Breaks the fast	Fine, in moderation
Bone broth, soup	Breaks the fast (has calories)	Fine
Meals and snacks	Breaks the fast	This is when you eat
Supplements without calories (vitamins, creatine powder in water)	Usually fine	Fine
Protein shakes, gels, BCAAs, gummies	Break the fast	Fine

PUT IT INTO PRACTICE

A sample week

One way a week could look. Portions and total food depend on you and your training.

	Breakfast	Lunch	Dinner
Mon	Window opens: eggs, toast, fruit	Chicken, rice, vegetables	Salmon, potatoes, salad (window closes)
Tue	Oats, banana, milk	Tuna wrap, salad	Beef stir-fry, noodles
Wed	Greek yoghurt, berries, granola	Lentil soup, bread	Chicken, rice, peppers
Thu	Omelette, toast	Jacket potato, beans, cheese	Turkey burgers, wedges
Fri	Smoothie and eggs	Chicken pasta	Fish, potatoes, greens
Sat	Pancakes, fruit	Leftover pasta	Pizza night (inside the window)
Sun	Window opens: full breakfast	Roast leftovers	Roast dinner

Snacks

Fruit · Nuts · Yoghurt · Boiled eggs · Rice cakes with nut butter

Shopping list

Protein foods for each meal · Easy carbs: oats, rice, potatoes, bread · Fruit and vegetables · Plain tea and coffee · Salt and electrolytes

GOOD TO KNOW

Questions people ask

What is the best window?

The one you can keep up. Many people choose late morning to early evening.

Will I lose muscle?

Not if you eat enough protein and train. Under-eating is the risk.

Is it good for fighters?

It can work off-camp. Many sports dietitians advise against it during hard training blocks or weight cuts.

Further reading

British Dietetic Association; reviews of time-restricted eating in major medical journals.

For fighters and combat athletes

- **No eating style makes a rapid weight cut safe.** Sweating, fluid restriction and crash diets hurt performance and can be dangerous. Plan any weight cut with a registered sports dietitian and your coach, well before the weigh-in.
- **Fuel the training first.** Hard sparring and conditioning need carbohydrate and enough total food. If a style cuts a food group, have a plan to replace what is lost.
- **Protein across the day.** A common general range for people training hard is about 1.4 to 2.0 g per kg of body weight a day (draft range, to be confirmed by a dietitian).
- **Try changes in training, never in fight week.** Test new foods, supplements and timing well before competition.
- **Under 18, pregnant, or with a medical condition:** get advice from a doctor or dietitian before changing your diet.

FIGHTERBASE

Train. Eat. Recover. Repeat.

Your eating styles library lives in the Nutrition tab. Pick a style, follow it, and get back to training.

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